

in this article. Even though PHP is almost always paired with HTML, it doesn't mean that you can't have standalone PHP scripts running offline in your machine, but it is a bit weird to use PHP to develop an application that only works in the offline mode. You may find some other programming languages that work better than PHP for such purposes.

The first PHP script we are going to run is a standalone PHP script called *first.php* shown below.

```
<?php
    echo 'I don\'t depend on HTML always';

?>
```

Execute the command `php -f first.php` in a terminal to run the script *first.php*. This and all the other PHP scripts and HTML files discussed in this article can be downloaded from opensourceforu.com/article_source_code/October17PHP.zip. It is also possible to make PHP scripts executable. Consider the slightly modified PHP script called *second.php* shown below.

```
#!/usr/bin/php
<?php
    echo 'I don\'t depend on HTML always';

?>
```

Execute the command `./second.php` in a terminal to run the script *second.php*. But before doing this, make sure that you have a PHP executable in your system. Sometimes this executable named 'php' may not be present in the directory `/usr/bin`. In that case, find the path to the 'php' executable and replace the line of code `#!/usr/bin/php` with the line of code `#!/YOUR_PATH_TO_PHP/php`. Also, make sure that you have the execute permission for the file *second.php*. Figure 1 shows the outputs of the two PHP scripts *first.php* and *second.php*.

The 'Hello World' script in PHP

In each of the articles in this series, I have discussed a different programming language but I never had the chance to discuss a 'Hello World' program. So here it is — the 'Hello World' script in PHP embedded inside HTML, called *hello.php*, is shown below:

```
<html>
<head>
<title>Hello World Script PHP</title>
</head>
<body>
<?php
    echo '<b> Hello World </b>';
```

```
?>
</body>
</html>
```

But to run this PHP script, you need a Web server like Apache. My system has XAMPP, which is a free and open source Web server solution stack that provides Apache HTTP Server and MariaDB, a database. XAMPP can also interpret PHP and Perl scripts on its own. Make sure you have Apache HTTP Server available in your system by using XAMPP or a similar LAMP based Web server solution stack. From this point onwards, I assume all of you have XAMPP in your system. Even if you are using a different Web server, it will not affect the output of the PHP scripts in this article. Just make sure that you know how to run PHP scripts with your Web server.

Now if you have XAMPP, use the command `sudo /opt/lampp/lampp start` in a terminal to start the XAMPP service. Of course, you will need root privileges to do this. After this, open a Web browser and type 'localhost' on the address bar. If the XAMPP service is running, you will see the welcome page of XAMPP. To run the PHP script *hello.php*, copy it into the directory `/opt/lampp/htdocs`. All the PHP scripts discussed in this article, except *first.php* and *second.php*, should be copied into this directory because we need a Web server to process them. But in the case of *first.php* and *second.php*, this is not necessary because they are standalone PHP scripts and can be executed from anywhere. Now, on the address bar of the Web browser, type `localhost/hello.php`. You will see the Web browser displaying the message 'Hello World' in bold. Figure 2 shows the output of the PHP script *hello.php* in the Mozilla Firefox Web browser.

Now let us examine the script *hello.php* in detail. Most of the HTML tags used in the script, like `<html>`, `<head>`, `<title>`, `<body>`, etc, are self-explanatory; so let us not waste time worrying about them. The PHP interpreter parses the PHP part of the script starting with the opening tag `<?php`

```
# php -f first.php
I don't depend on HTML always
# ./second.php
I don't depend on HTML always
```

Figure 1: Output of standalone PHP scripts

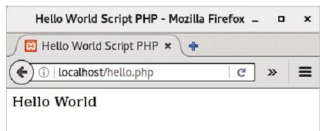


Figure 2: 'Hello World' in PHP